Tip: Use graphics to set the tone of the speech.

Introduction to the Holy Qur'an and Its Sciences

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Tip: The thesis should be clear and bold. Use powerful images as a background or an accent to strengthen the thesis statement.

Introduction to the Holy Qur'an and Its Sciences

The Meaning of the Word "Qur'an"

- Derived from the Arabic root ق ر أ **(q-r-ʾ)** meaning *to read* or *to recite.*
- *Qur'an* means **"the recitation"** — a message meant to be recited and memorized.
- Allah says:

"Indeed, this Qur'an guides to that which is most upright." (17:9)

- It is both **a Book to be read** and **a Revelation to be lived.**

Other Names of the Qur'an

Name	Meaning	Significance
al-Kitāb	The Book	Written guidance
al-Furqān	The Criterion	Differentiates truth and falsehood
al-Dhikr	The Reminder	Spiritual awakening
al-Tanzīl	The Revelation	Sent down from Allah

Each name highlights a unique dimension of the Qur'an's message.

Meaning of Divine Revelation (Waḥy)

- **Definition:**
  A special communication from Allah to His prophets conveying divine guidance.
- **Qur'anic Basis:**
- "It is not for any human that Allah should speak to him except by revelation, or from behind a veil, or by sending a messenger (angel)." *(al-Shūrā 42:51)*
- **Purpose:**
- To convey guidance, laws, and spiritual truths.
- To connect humanity with divine will.

Modes of Revelation

- **Inspiration (Ilhām):**
  Placed directly into the heart (e.g., revelation to the mother of Mūsā).
- **From behind a veil (Min warāʾ ḥijāb):**
  Allah's direct speech, as with Prophet Mūsā (Kalimullāh).
- **Through an angel (Jibrīl):**
  The most frequent mode — the Prophet ﷺ received revelation via Jibrīl.

Intellectual Doubts About Revelation

Doubt 1: Revelation is a psychological or emotional experience.

- **Answer:** Revelation transcends human psychology — it is divine communication confirmed by miracles, coherence, and prophecy.

Doubt 2: Why is revelation limited to a few prophets?

- **Answer:** Prophethood is a divine trust, ensuring that guidance remains clear, consistent, and universally transmitted.

Qur'anic vs. Non-Qur'anic Revelation

Type	Description	Example
Qur'anic Revelation	Word-for-word from Allah; recited in prayers; part of the Qur'an.	Surah al-Fātiḥa, Surah al-Baqarah
Non-Qur'anic Revelation	Meaning revealed, words chosen by the Prophet ;ﷺrecorded as Ḥadīth.	Ḥadīth Qudsī

History of the Revelation of the Qur'an

- Began on **Laylat al-Qadr** (The Night of Power) in **Ramadan**.
- **Two stages of revelation:**
  1. From al-Lawḥ al-Maḥfūẓ (Preserved Tablet) to Bayt al-ʿIzzah (Lowest Heaven).
  2. Gradual revelation over **23 years** according to circumstances.
- **Purpose:** Gradual moral and social transformation of the community.

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Makkan and Madinan Verses

Aspect	Makkan Verses	Madinan Verses
Period	Before Hijrah	After Hijrah
Themes	Faith, Tawḥīd, Hereafter, morality	Law, society, worship, governance
Style	Short, rhythmic, emotional	Detailed, legislative, instructive
Audience	Polytheists of Makkah	Believers, Jews, Christians